VERBAL

Reading Comprehension

Inference, Title & Tone

Assignment 3

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DIRECTIONS ***for the question 1:*** *Read the following paragraph carefully and answer the question that follows:*

It is one week since Uttarakhand's worst disaster in living memory. Flash floods resulting from extremely intense rainfall swept away mountainsides, villages and towns, thousands of people, animals, agricultural fields, irrigation canals, domestic water sources, dams, roads, bridges, and buildings — anything that stood in the way.

A week later, media attention remains riveted on the efforts to rescue tens of thousands of pilgrims and tourists visiting the shrines in the uppermost reaches of Uttarakhand's sacred rivers. But the deluge spread far beyond the Char Dhams— Yamunotri, Gangotri,^ Kedarnath and Badrinath— to cover the entire state. The catchments of many smaller rivers also witnessed flash floods but the media has yet to report on the destruction there. Eyewitness accounts being gathered by official agencies and voluntary organizations have reported devastation from more than 200 villages so far and more affected villages are being reported every day.

1. Which of the following would the author agree the most with?

1. *Char Dhams*were most affected by Uttarakhand disaster.
2. Entire catchment of rivers flowing in Uttarakhand was affected.
3. Media attention was on *Char Dhams* but the entire catchment area of rivers flowing in Uttarakhand was affected.
4. Media cannot be trusted as it focuses only on important places and events.
5. Voluntary organizations are better than media in reaching out to the affected people.

DIRECTIONS ***for questions 2 - 4:*** *Analyze the following passage and provide appropriate answers for the question that follows.*

I heartily accept the motto, "That government is best which governs least"; and I should like to see it acted up to more rapidly and systematically. Carried out, it finally amounts to this, which also I believe--"That government is best which governs not at all"; and when men are prepared for it, that will be the kind of government which they will have. Government is at best but an expedient; but most governments are usually, and all governments are sometimes, inexpedient. The objections which have been brought against a standing army, and they are many and weighty, and deserve to prevail, may also at last be brought against a standing government. The standing army is only an arm of the standing government. The government itself, which is only the mode which the people have chosen to execute their will, is equally liable to be abused and perverted before the people can act through it.

After all, the practical reason why, when the power is once in the hands of the people, a majority are permitted, and for a long period continue, to rule is not because they are most likely to be in the right, nor because this seems fairest to the minority, but because they are physically the strongest. But a government in which the majority rules in all cases cannot be based on justice, even as far as men understand it. Can there not be a government in which the majorities do not virtually decide right and wrong, but conscience?~in which majorities decide only those questions to which the rule of expediency is applicable? Must the citizen ever for a moment, or in the least degree, resign his conscience to the legislator? Why has every man a conscience then? I think that we should be men first, and subjects afterward. It is not desirable to cultivate a respect for the law, so much as for the right. The only obligation which I have a right to assume is to do at any time what I think right. It is truly enough said that a corporation has no conscience; but a corporation of conscientious men is a corporation with a conscience. Law never made men a whit more just; and, by means of their respect for it, even the well-disposed are daily made the agents on injustice.

2. According to the author of the paragraph, army is_____?

1. required 2. fallible 3. must 4. necessary evil 5. not required

3. *In general,* when would government of majority be good for minorities?

1. when it is fair.
2. when it is right.
3. when it abides by the law.
4. when it is conscientious.
5. such a government cannot exist.

4. Which of the following statements would the author agree the most with?

1. Men are bigger than the governments.
2. Business houses are best for the growth of a society.
3. Governments and armies are not required.
4. Concept of nations is redundant.
5. Democracy is best for citizens.

DIRECTIONS ***for questions 5 - 7:*** *Analyze the following passage and provide appropriate answers for the question that follows.*

The assumption of rationality puts an economist in a position to "explain" some features of market behavior, such as the dispersion of prices of psychophysically identical goods such as beer according to the amount spent on advertising them (no doubt, the fact that most beer is bought by individuals rather than as a raw material by firms, which could be expected to be more rational than individuals, is part of the explanation). Clearly, something is wrong somewhere with the usual model of a competitive market with perfect information, for the virtually content-less advertising cannot be considered as increasing the utility of beer in an obvious way. But if one can keep the assumption of rational actors, one need not get into the intellectual swamp of sentiment nor of preferences that depend on price. If one agrees, for example, that consumers use advertising as an index of the effort a producer will put into protecting its reputation and so as a predictor of quality control efforts, one can combine it with the standard mechanism and derive testable consequences from it.

But why, logically speaking, does it not matter that any of us, with a few years' training, could disprove the assumptions? It is for the same reason that the statistical mechanics of gases is not undermined when Rutherford teaches a lot of only moderately bright physicists to use X-ray diffraction to disprove the assumption that molecules are little hard elastic balls. The point is, departures that Rutherford teaches us to find from the mechanism built into statistical mechanics are small and hardly ever systematic at the level of gases. Ignorance and error about the quality of beer is also, unlikely to be systematic at the level of the consumers' beer market, though it would become systematic if buyers imposed quality control procedures on sellers in contracts of sale (as corporations very often do in their contracts with suppliers). So, when we find beers that are apparently psychophysically identical selling for prices that depend on their advertising budgets, we have a dull alternative hypothesis and an interesting one. The dull one is that advertising can make the ignorance and error systematic at the level of markets, just as lasers with wavelengths resonant with the internal structures and the sizes of molecules can make molecular motions in gases systematic. The interesting one is that virtually content-less advertising is nevertheless information to a rational actor.

5. Which of the following statements would be the closest to the arguments in the passage?

1. Individuals are more rational than firms.
2. Firms are rational.
3. Firms are more rational than individuals.
4. Firms are, most of the times, more rational than individuals.
5. Market behavior of psychophysical goods would be the same as that of physical goods.

6. Why has the author referred to Rutherford in the passage?

1. To prove that molecules are elastic.
2. To highlight that we should not compare apples and oranges.
3. To hint that only very good students understood Physics taught by Rutherford.
4. To equate beer with little hard elastic balls.
5. To state that Mechanics is more amenable to application of Statistics than gasses.

7. Which of the following, as per author, are psychophysical goods?

1. Concrete 2. Car 3. Mobile Phone

1. 1 and 2 2. 2 and 3 3. 1 and 3 4. 1,2 and 3 5. None of these

DIRECTIONS ***for questions 8 - 10:*** *Analyze the following passage and provide appropriate answers for the question that follows.*

The ways by which you may get money almost without exception lead downward. To have done anything by which you earned money merely is to have been truly idle or worse. If the laborer gets no more than the wages which his employer pays him, he is cheated, he cheats himself. If you would get money as a writer or lecturer, you must be popular, which is to go down perpendicularly. Those services which the community will most readily pay for, it is most disagreeable to render. You are paid for being something less than a man. The State does not commonly reward a genius any more wisely. Even the poet laureate would rather not have to celebrate the accidents of royalty. He must be bribed with a pipe of wine; and perhaps another poet is called away from his muse to gauge that very pipe. The aim of the laborer should be, not to get his living, to get "a good job," but to perform well a certain work; and, even in a pecuniary sense, it would be economy for a town to pay its laborers so well that they would not feel that they were working for low ends, as for a livelihood merely, but for scientific, or even moral ends. Do not hire a man who does your work for money, but him who does it for love of it.

The community has no bribe that will tempt a wise man. You may raise money enough to tunnel a mountain, but you cannot raise money enough to hire a man who is minding his own business. An efficient and valuable man does what he can, whether the community pays him for it or not. The inefficient offer their inefficiency to the highest bidder, and are forever expecting to be put into office. One would suppose that they were rarely disappointed. God gave the righteous man a certificate entitling him to food and raiment, but the unrighteous man found a facsimile of the same in God's coffers, and appropriated it, and obtained food and raiment like the former. It is one of the most extensive systems of counterfeiting that the world has seen. I did not know that mankind was suffering for want of gold. I have seen a little of it. I know that it is very malleable, but not so malleable as wit. A grain of gold will gild a great surface, but not so much as a grain of wisdom.

8. Which of the following would the author disagree most with?

1. Setting up a factory in a rural area
2. Advertising for tooth paste
3. Studying in a business school
4. Betting in a casino
5. Working for an investment bank

9. Which of the following could be a good title for the above passage?

1. Money and Work
2. God Rush
3. Work is Worship
4. In Search for God
5. God is Gold

10. The author of the passage went on to say: *"We are provincial, because we do not find at home our standards; because we do not worship truth, but the reflection of truth; because we are warped and narrowed by an exclusive devotion to trade and commerce and manufactures and agriculture and the like, which are but means, and not the end."*

Which of the following, as per author, could have been *the end* (last words in the lines above)?

1. Economic growth of society 2. Realization of self
3. Happy family life 4. Strong and powerful nation
5. Distribution of wealth

Answer keys

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1.	3	The media paid high attention on 'char dham' inspite of the fact the other areas were also badly affected. Hence the answer is option 3
2.	2	The author says that army like governments is inexpedient and there can be so many objections can be raised against so many them. Hence answer is option 2
3.	4	After reading the last few lines author emphasizes that government and hence legislators can deliver justice or give fair treatment to a minority if decisions are conscientious. Hence answer is option 4
4.	1	In the last few lines the author says 'we should be men first and subjects afterwards'.. This refers to option A as the best.
5.	4	As per the lines from the first Para '… the fact that most beer …. Clearly something is wrong somewhere… points out that the answer is option 4.
6.	2	The author has given thy example of 'Rutherford' experiment is to prove that incomparable things should not be compared.
7.	5	None of the options fall under the category of psychophysical goods except for a concrete little' as it is not 'concrete', the perception of which may or may not change after increasing or decreasing the advertising budget. Hence answer is option 5.
8.	4	As per the author one should undertake the career out of love for that particular area/work and not for the money/remuneration. 'Betting in a casino' is solely for sake of making money out of greed and that is not desirable as per the author. Therefore author will not agree with the option 4.
9.	3	In the entire passage the author is talking about the way one should pick up/choose the career/work and it should not be solely based on wages one will get or if it is a lucrative opportunity. On the contrary the choice of career/work should be as per the liking/love for that work/job. Finally he wants to prove that work is of prime importance and not the money involved. Therefore the best tile will be option 3 as when 'worship' takes the front seat then other factors such as money will take the back seat.
10.	2	The author in the lines say that 'we are narrow when it comes to searching for truth instead we keep on moving around the perceptions, which we consider truth where there is none. We consider only the means and do not worry or think about the results. Therefore it should be realization of truth above all rather than running after perishables. Hence the answer is option 2.